



Figure 1: Virtual desktop set-up



Figure 2: The Ulteo menu for applications

The GIMP, Inkscape and many others.

After downloading it successfully, double click on the set-up (.exe) file. You will be greeted by a welcome screen (Figure 1).

Follow the on screen instructions, and if everything goes fine, within five minutes Ulteo Virtual Desktop will be installed on your Windows system. Could getting started with Linux have been any easier? It's like installing any application on Windows, with an additional benefit: it doesn't even require a Windows reboot to work properly. The virtual desktop contains a virtual filesystem of around 5 GB, as a disk file in your Windows directories where "everything will happen".

Run the Ulteo virtual desktop and you will see a panel at the top of the screen. You can browse through all the Linux applications by using the drop-down menu as shown in Figure 2. Of course, you can configure the panel according to your liking by using the **Configure Panel** option.

I guess you've figured out by now that running Linux applications alongside Windows apps at the same time is as easy as a piece of cake. Figure 3 shows some applications in action. Table 1 lists the applications included in the Ulteo virtual desktop.

The default user will be created with the user name 'me'.



Figure 3: Run Linux apps as if they are native Windows programs



Figure 4: Running a full-fledged KDE on Windows

The password for the user 'me' is, well, 'me' by default! The 'root' user password is 'root'. Ulteo Virtual Desktop contains many useful commands to work on the Linux Command Line Interface (CLI). You can also start KDE by using the **startkde** command. The KDE desktop is shown in Figure 4.

I won't carry on more about this and that feature, but request you to explore the world of Linux applications yourself. Once you get used to them, I'm sure you'll take a step in the right direction.

Of course, whenever you plan to uninstall the Ulteo VD from your Windows because you want to install an independent Linux operating system in your PC, go to the Windows control panel and under the **Add or Remove Programs** section, you will find Ulteo VD. Uninstall it the way you uninstall any other software in Windows.

However, before you do this, you better have a separate Linux installation in a dedicated hard disk partition, or else... 

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Sandeep loves to test new open source tools and believes in helping people try out open source applications.